



YOU ARE **15 WEEKS EXACTLY**
175 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This profile view shows that the bridge of the nose is shallow and the eyes are still dominating the face. The jaw is lengthening and the chin held away from the chest. The hands (with outstretched fingers) are in a common position—close to the face.

“It’s worthwhile finding comfortable sleeping positions now; these will stand you in good stead throughout pregnancy.”

Your belly will be getting bigger by the day and, as a result, you may find it increasingly difficult to get comfortable when you’re lying down, especially during the night.

You should avoid sleeping on your back in the second half of your pregnancy, so start practicing some new positions now. This is because the weight of your uterus will press on the major veins that return blood to your heart, which may result in dizziness, low blood pressure, and possibly a reduction in blood flow to the uterus.

Ideally, lie on your left side as this is actually good for you and the baby, although it won’t harm you or your baby to lie on your right side. It improves blood flow to the placenta and helps your kidneys eliminate fluids and waste products. Don’t worry if you wake to find you’re lying on your back: just roll onto your side and support yourself with pillows if necessary.

It’s fine to lie on your front if you prefer (your baby is safely cushioned in the amniotic fluid), but the bigger you get, the more difficult this will become.

QUIET TIMES

Times when you can focus quietly on your baby are precious bonding opportunities and a great way to relax. You may want to visualize your baby floating in the amniotic fluid.

Try this “butterfly” pose with the soles of your feet together. Place your hands on your abdomen and massage your baby using different strokes. Think of your baby and shed your preoccupations with each out-breath.